



JEFFREY C. MCKAY
CHAIRMAN

COMMONWEALTH OF VIRGINIA
County of Fairfax
BOARD OF SUPERVISORS

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February 3, 2026

The Honorable L. Louise Lucas
Chair, Virginia Senate Finance and Appropriations Committee
P. O. Box 396
Richmond, VA 23218

Dear Chair Lucas:

On behalf of the Fairfax County Board of Supervisors, we are writing in support of a budget amendment to increase funding for Specially Adapted Resources Clubs (SPARC). There are many budget amendments the Board supports in addition to this one, but we wanted to take an opportunity to showcase this important work.

SPARC provides essential day programs for adults with disabilities at six locations in Northern Virginia. These programs offer participants a supportive structure and a variety of educational services to build life skills while socializing with peers.

In January 2012, the Commonwealth entered into a settlement agreement with the U.S. Department of Justice concerning services for individuals with developmental disabilities. In January 2025, a permanent injunction was approved, formally concluding the settlement while continuing the Commonwealth's obligation to provide services in the most integrated setting appropriate. SPARC plays a critical role in helping the Commonwealth meet these obligations.

The proposed budget amendments submitted by Delegate Reid and Senator Boysko (Items 300 #7h and 300 #8s) would fully fund SPARC's operations through the state budget and enable the Department of Behavioral Health and Developmental Services (DBHDS) to continue contracting with SPARC at a level that reflects the actual cost of providing services. This funding is essential to sustaining SPARC's proven, participant-directed, community-integrated model.

SPARC's participant-directed, community-integrated model also directly advances in a cost-effective manner the Commonwealth's obligations under the permanent injunction and the Americans with Disabilities Act's (ADA) mandate to provide services to individuals with developmental disabilities in the most integrated setting appropriate to their needs.

Fairfax County has long been a leader in disability inclusion and community-based services, and we greatly appreciate your attention to this important matter. Continued state investment in SPARC is a cost-

The Honorable Luke E. Torian

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effective way to advance the Commonwealth's responsibilities under the permanent injunction and the Americans with Disabilities Act, while ensuring adults with developmental disabilities have meaningful opportunities to live, learn, and engage in their communities.

Please do not hesitate to contact us if you have questions or need further information, or have your staff contact Jennifer Van Ee, Legislative Director, at (703) 324-2640.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading "Jeff McKay". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Jeff" and last name "McKay" clearly distinguishable.

Jeffrey C. McKay
Chairman
Fairfax County Board of Supervisors

A handwritten signature in blue ink, reading "Andres F. Jimenez". The signature is fluid and cursive, with a long horizontal stroke extending to the right.

Andres F. Jimenez
Legislative Chairman
Fairfax County Board of Supervisors

cc: The Honorable Jennifer B. Boysko
The Honorable David W. Marsden
The Honorable Scott Surovell